

Chapter 5

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 5: Problem-Solving and Decision-Making

This worksheet is designed for high school students as part of the **Self-Advocacy & Confidence Building for Teens** course. It aligns with Chapter 5 content on problem-solving, decision-making, and conflict resolution, encouraging reflection, practical application, and skill-building through a variety of activities. The worksheet can be completed individually or used as a discussion tool in a classroom or group setting.

Part 1: Steps to Effective Problem-Solving

Objective: Practice identifying problems and brainstorming solutions to build a structured approach to challenges.

- **Define in Your Own Words (Short Answer)**

- What does problem-solving mean to you, and why is it a useful skill for teens?

- **Problem Detective Challenge (Reflection and Brainstorming)** Think of a current problem you're facing (e.g., too much homework, a fight with a friend). Write down the specific issue (not just "I'm stressed"). Then, brainstorm at least 5 possible solutions—include one silly or creative idea for fun.

- My Specific Problem: _____

- Brainstormed Solutions:

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- (Silly/Creative) _____

- **Solution Showdown (Evaluation Activity)** From your brainstorm above, pick two solutions that seem most realistic. List one pro and one con for each, then choose which one you'll try first and why.

- Solution 1: _____ Pro: _____ Con: _____

- Solution 2: _____ Pro: _____ Con: _____

- Which I'll Try First and Why: _____

Part 2: Making Informed Decisions

Objective: Develop skills to weigh options and balance advice with personal instincts for confident choices.

- **Decision Dilemma (Pros and Cons Practice)** Think of a decision you need to make soon (e.g., joining a club, picking a weekend plan). List two options, then write at least 2 pros and 2 cons for each. Circle the option you're leaning toward.

- Decision Topic: _____
- Option 1: _____ Pros: 1. _____ 2. _____ Cons: 1. _____ 2. _____
- Option 2: _____ Pros: 1. _____ 2. _____ Cons: 1. _____ 2. _____
- My Leaning Choice: _____

- **Gut Check vs. Advice (Reflection)** For the decision above, who could you ask for advice (e.g., friend, parent)? What might they say? Then, check in with your gut—what feels right to you, and why?

- Who I Could Ask: _____
- What They Might Say: _____
- My Gut Feeling and Why: _____

- **Decision Avatar Game (Creative Goal-Setting)** Imagine your decision-making skill as a superhero avatar with a special power to help you choose wisely. Name your avatar and describe or sketch its look (e.g., cape, gadget). Set a goal to use a pros/cons list for one decision this week and note how it goes.

- Avatar Name: _____
- Description/Sketch Notes: _____
- My Decision Goal This Week: _____
- Result After Trying: _____

Part 3: Handling Conflict Constructively

Objective: Learn to stay calm and negotiate solutions during disagreements for better relationships.

- **Conflict Cool-Down (Scenario Practice)** Read the scenario below and write how you'd stay calm and start a constructive convo. Use a tip like deep breathing or an "I feel" statement.
 - **Scenario:** Your friend keeps borrowing stuff without asking, and it's annoying you. Today, they took your favorite hoodie again. How I'd Stay Calm: _____ What I'd Say: _____
- **Win-Win Negotiation (Reflection)** Think of a recent disagreement (big or small). What was it about? How did you handle it? Suggest a win-win solution you could've tried (or did try) to make both sides happy.
 - Disagreement: _____
 - How I Handled It: _____
 - Win-Win Idea: _____
- **Conflict Peacekeeper Simulator (Creative Strategy)** Imagine conflicts are "glitches" in a game, and you're a peacekeeper with a special move to fix them. Pick a recent or made-up conflict and create a "peace move" name. Write the calm statement or compromise you'd use to solve it.
 - Conflict/Glitch: _____
 - Peace Move Name: _____
 - Statement or Compromise: _____

Part 4: Problem-Solver Pro Badge (Final Challenge) Over the next week, pick one skill from this chapter to focus on (e.g., brainstorming solutions, staying calm in conflict). Once you've used it, design a mini "Problem-Solver Pro Badge" below—name it and describe or sketch its symbol (like a brain or handshake).

- Skill Goal: _____
- Badge Name: _____
- Symbol Description/Sketch Notes: _____
- How/When I'll Earn It: _____